PRODUCTBEACON RESEARCH · WEM RADAR

A standard for customers' AI agents. An AI-agent vendor starts scheduling staff.

Weekly summary · 10 October 2026

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THE PROTOCOL

Sierra and Meta launch an open standard for customers' personal AI agents.

- The Personal Agent Protocol, announced on 6 October, sets how a customer's own AI agent signs in and acts with a business.
- Sierra names Genesys, Instinct, Rocket, Shopify, Stripe and Walmart as partners. Salesforce is not a named partner.
- The customer chooses read-only or write access. The personal agent identifies itself, so the business knows when an agent acts for a customer.
- On 9 October Sierra published a draft and added 35 design partners, including OpenAI, Zendesk, Bank of America and Visa.

> Why it matters: Sierra says personal agents that fail on a website "may call the company's support line or open its web chat." Watch: the first specification, planned for later in October.

SOURCES Sierra, 6 Oct · Sierra, 9 Oct · Salesforce, 9 Oct

THE SCHEDULE

An AI-agent vendor starts scheduling the human team.

- Lorikeet, which sells AI customer-service agents, launched Workforce Manager on 7 October. It builds rosters from ticket and call volume and checks each shift against working rules.
- It is built for support teams of 20 or more agents on chat or phones. It shows staffing shortfalls up to 12 months ahead.
- Lorikeet said that by 9 October the tool would also fix the live schedule by itself. We could not confirm that this feature has shipped.
- The tool has no published price and no named customer.

> Our view: this is the first offer in our coverage of software changing the live schedule by itself. Watch: whether it ships, at what price and with which customers.

SOURCES Lorikeet, 7 Oct

THE NUMBERS

Fin 4 comes with two resolution rates. No tracked vendor returns to seats.

- Fin, owned by Salesforce since 10 September, launched Fin 4 on 7 October. It adds proactive onboarding and a confidence score for human review.
- Fin says it averages a 76% resolution rate. A Fin page dated 9 October gives 67% across all customers, with early-stage teams at 76%.
- Both are Fin's own figures, from two pages. Its price stays $0.99 per outcome; the Pro add-on rose from $99 to $100 a month.
- Across nine public price pages, no tracked vendor moved from per-resolution pricing back to per-seat pricing.

> Our view: Fin's two pages differ by nine points, so each figure needs its page and date.

SOURCES Fin, 7 Oct · Fin, 8 Oct · Fin, 9 Oct · Fin pricing, 10 Oct

THE DEALS

Automation Anywhere agrees to buy Boost.ai. TCN starts folding in Abstrakt.

- Automation Anywhere agreed on 7 October to buy Boost.ai, a chat and voice AI vendor, from Nordic Capital. Terms were not disclosed.
- TCN told Abstrakt customers on 7 October they now get one TCN bill. TCN says “full native integration will take time.”
- Flyle, a contact-centre AI agent company, raised a ¥1.88 billion (about $12.6 million) Series A, FinTech Observer reports. Salesforce Ventures took part.
- An earlier deal: Genesys bought Pinkfish on 30 June, CMSWire reports. Pinkfish connects AI agents to about 25,000 tools.

> Our view: an automation company buying a customer-facing AI vendor is a new exit route for mid-sized specialists.

SOURCES Boost.ai, 7 Oct · TCN, 7 Oct · FinTech Observer, 9 Oct · CMSWire, 30 Jun

THE RULES

Colorado’s revised draft rules presume a score a manager sees influenced the decision.

- Colorado’s Attorney General posted a revised draft of its automated-decision rules on 6 October. Comments close on 26 October.
- Tools used only to summarise, organise, translate, draft or route information for human review fall outside the draft rules.
- In the draft’s promotion example, a manager sees each candidate’s score. The score is presumed to have influenced the decision. The state asks for alternatives.
- In California, law firm Epstein Becker Green names “call-center sentiment analysis” among the “likeliest trouble spots” under the emotion-AI ban.

> Our view: if the draft holds, scores that Colorado managers see before people decisions will need documented human judgment.

SOURCES Colorado, 6 Oct · Epstein Becker Green, 7 Oct

THE JOBS

Fewer contact-centre jobs and strained outsourcers, with mixed evidence on AI.

- Revelio Labs estimates global call-centre employment is 5.3% below its December 2023 peak. Its figures are modelled from online professional profiles.
- Concentrix expects fourth-quarter revenue to fall 3% to 5% at constant currency. Its chief executive said: “we are aggressively disrupting our own traditional business.”
- TTEC’s lenders cut its credit line to $960 million. Its loan margin rises on 16 November unless amended again.
- Against: Challenger says AI was cited for about 9% of US job cuts in September. HubSpot said its cuts were “not driven by AI-related efficiencies.”

> Our view: the evidence of fewer human seats is growing, but employers rarely name AI as the cause.

SOURCES Revelio Labs, 6 Oct · Concentrix, 29 Sep · TTEC, 7 Oct · Challenger, 1 Oct · HubSpot, 6 Oct

THE QUALITY SCORE

Quality scoring now covers people and AI agents.

- Amazon Connect now suggests rewording quality-review questions so AI can score them reliably. Amazon says this helps score “human and AI agents fairly.”
- Microsoft’s quality tool can now run recurring, bulk and sampled reviews, not only one check when a conversation closes.
- Parloa introduced a “Relationship Score” out of 100 for AI-handled conversations, built from more than 50 AI-judged checks. It announced no price or customer figures.
- Zenarate reports TruGreen cut onboarding time by 50% and Sallie Mae cut staff turnover by 32%. These are vendor figures.

> Our view: quality measurement is moving to one standard for people and bots.

SOURCES Amazon, 9 Oct · Microsoft, 5 Oct · Parloa, 8 Oct · Zenarate, 8 Oct

SOURCES

Sources behind this week's news.

Company announcements, official records and reporting:

COMPANY ANNOUNCEMENTS

Sierra · Salesforce · Lorikeet · Fin · Boost.ai · TCN · Amazon · Microsoft · Parloa · Zenarate

OFFICIAL RECORDS AND FILINGS

Colorado (draft rules) · Concentrix · TTEC · HubSpot

RESEARCH AND PRESS REPORTING

Revelio Labs · Challenger · Epstein Becker Green · FinTech Observer · CMSWire

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Source links and detailed citations accompany the full weekly summary.

FULL DISCLOSURE

Personal AI agents get a standard. Staff scheduling gets an AI offer.

Sierra and Meta's standard sets how customers' own AI agents sign in and act with a business. Lorikeet says its new tool can fix the live schedule by itself; we could not confirm that feature has shipped. Our view: quality measurement is moving to one standard for people and bots.

→ **Read the full report**

productbeacon.agency/research/state-of-wem-2026

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